Health and safety education

Seminar: from knowing to doing

Dr Wonyong Park | EDUC1033 Week 10 · Seminar



School crossing patrol · Pauline E, geograph.org.uk, CC BY-SA 2.0

Recap: why knowing may not change what people do

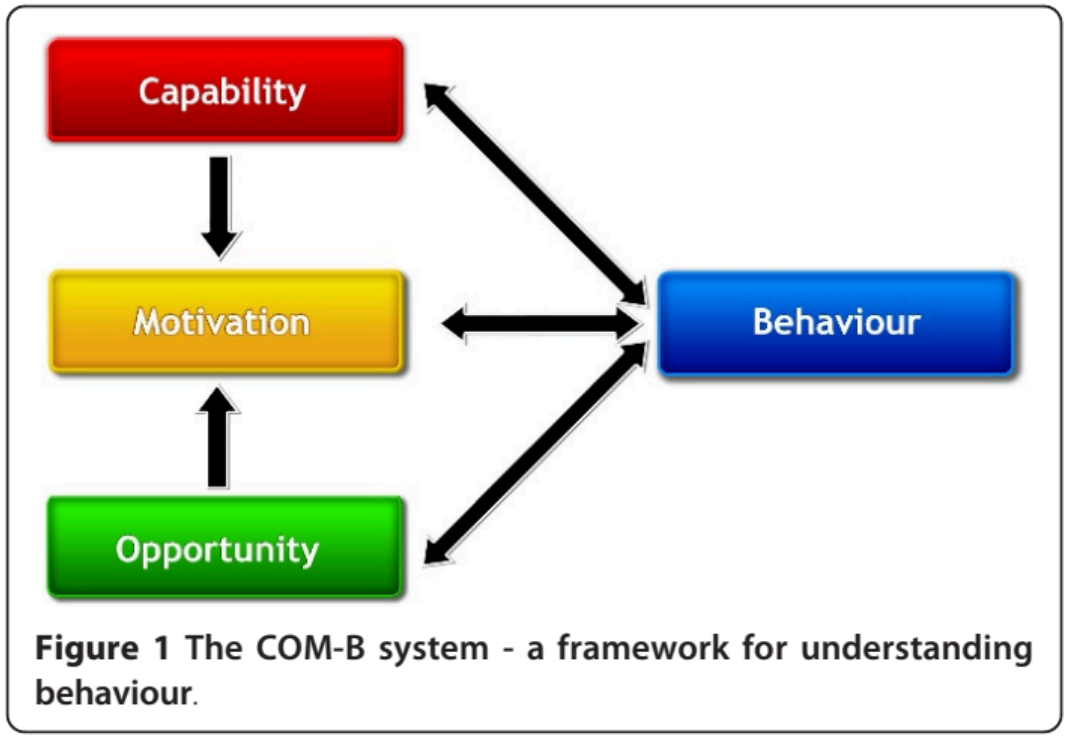


Figure 1 The COM-B system - a framework for understanding behaviour.

Capability	Knowledge and practical skills
Opportunity	Physical circumstances (time, money, places, equipment) and social ones (friends, family, norms)
Motivation	Reflective intentions, and automatic processes such as habit and enjoyment

Lessons mostly build capability. Opportunity and motivation often depend on conditions outside the lesson.

Michie, van Stralen & West (2011), Figure 1, p. 4. CC BY 2.0.

Recap: health literacy and the LifeLab evidence

Health literacy (Nutbeam)

Functional	using basic information, such as a food label
Interactive	asking questions and seeking support
Critical	evaluating claims and the conditions that shape health

Southampton LifeLab

0.27 SD	gain in **theoretical health literacy** after 12 months, 38 schools
Not shown	improvement in **diet or physical activity**, in either trial
Limited	pupil engagement with the **EACH-B app**; LifeLab itself was valued

Nutbeam (2000, 2025); Woods-Townsend et al. (2021); Barker et al. (2026); Jenner et al. (2025).

Recap: school safety is more than a lesson

Responsibility

The employer or proprietor is accountable. Pupils can help spot problems, but knowing a rule cannot make up for unsafe conditions.

Hierarchy of controls

Elimination, substitution and engineering controls before administrative controls and protective equipment. Change the setting before relying on behaviour.

Three pillars

Safer facilities; safety and continuity management; risk reduction and resilience education, on a foundation of systems and policies.

DfE (2022), sections 1–5; GADRRRES (2022), pp. 1–3.

Scenario: healthy eating in a Year 9 tutor group

Pupils have had lessons on balanced diets and can explain them. Six things they say about what they actually eat:

A "We learned about balanced meals, but I've never actually cooked one."

B "The lunch queue takes most of the break, so I grab something on the way in."

C "My parents work late, and there's not much in to cook with."

D "Everyone in my group gets the same snack after school. It's just what we do."

E "I know fruit is better for me. I just don't fancy it."

F "The healthier options at the shop near us cost more."

Hypothetical scenario, built from the barriers described in Michie et al. (2011) and WHO (1986).

Activity 1

Groups of 3–4 | 15 minutes

Sort statements A–F into capability, opportunity and motivation. Some may fit more than one.

Which barriers could another lesson address, and which need the school, families or others to change something?

Propose one change the school could make that does not rely on pupils trying harder.

The Comprehensive School Safety Framework



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kW78UK5UMaY · GADRRRES, *The Comprehensive School Safety Framework* (6 min)

As you watch, note

- What belongs in each of the three pillars
- What sits at the centre, and what forms the foundation
- Who the framework expects to act

You will use the pillars in Activity 2.

GADRRRES (2022), *Comprehensive School Safety Framework 2022–2030*.

Scenario: a school facing repeated hot days

The school

- A secondary school has several very hot days each summer term
- Top-floor classrooms overheat; the playing field has little shade
- Summer exams take place in the sports hall
- Some pupils travel long distances on foot or by bus
- Letters home go out by one app, in English

From the sources

- In April 2024, **123 million** students worldwide had schooling disrupted, mostly by heatwaves (UNICEF, 2025)
- Recurring overheating may need changes to **buildings and routines**, not only advice (GADRRRES, 2022)
- Continuity plans should ask which pupils face **extra barriers** and how families receive information

Hypothetical scenario. UNICEF (2025), Figure 1, p. 3; GADRRRES (2022).

Activity 2

Groups of 3–4 | 20 minutes

Plan the school's response to repeated hot days. Give at least one action under each pillar:

1 · Safer learning facilities	2 · Safety and continuity management	3 · Risk reduction and resilience education

a Which pupils might face extra barriers, and how does your plan reach them?

b Which actions rely on pupils' behaviour, and which change the setting?

Bringing the two activities together

In both scenarios, lessons build **capability**: knowing about diet, or about heat and wellbeing.

Whether that knowledge can be used depends on **opportunity**: lunch queues, cost, shade, water, timetables.

Many of those conditions are the **institution's responsibility**, shared with families and services.

Exit question

Name one thing a school, not a pupil, should be responsible for in health or safety, and say why.

Michie et al. (2011); WHO (1986); GADRRRES (2022).